

CRIZ — Planning Phase Summary

Admin IQ | Laabu AI Workforce

Item	Details
Project	Laabu AI Workforce
Agent	Admin IQ (CRIZ)
Document type	Planning Phase Summary
Lifecycle phase	Phase 1 - Planning
Status	Draft for review
Current deployment target	Google Cloud first, with a cloud-neutral application core

Executive summary

CRIZ is the operations backbone of the Laabu AI Workforce. It coordinates vendor and partner activity, supports internal office and approval workflows, and keeps operational processes moving across departments without removing people from sensitive decisions.

CRIZ has two user modes:

- **External Partner and Vendor Concierge** - supports vendor onboarding, compliance verification, contract coordination, e-signature workflow support, partner communications, and document collection and validation.
- **Internal Operations and Workflow Assistant** - supports contract review, meeting scheduling and coordination, travel planning and approvals, procurement workflow management, office operations support, task tracking and follow-ups, executive assistance, and approval routing and workflow orchestration.

The first release will prove one complete operational flow: a new vendor moves through onboarding, compliance review, approval routing, contract activation, and a closing audit record. The agent will never independently approve contracts, vendors, payments, or compliance decisions - human approval is required for every sensitive action.

The first implementation is on Google Cloud. Operational rules and agent logic stay separate from cloud-specific code, so another approved cloud provider can be added later without rewriting the whole agent.

1. Project context

Laabu is a connected group of business agents. A shared knowledge agent provides approved company information and routes work to specialist agents. CRIZ is the specialist for operations, vendor, and office-workflow tasks, and works alongside agents such as FINA (finance) on shared business processes.

CRIZ receives and emits important business events that other agents rely on:

- `vendor_onboarded` - signals that a vendor has completed intake and document submission.
- `compliance_status` - shows whether a compliance review is pending, flagged, or cleared.

- `contract_status` - shows whether a contract is drafted, signed, or active; this event is shared with FINA, which uses an active contract to trigger billing.
- `approval_required` - pauses a sensitive action until a person reviews it.
- `approved_by` - confirms that an authorized person approved the action.

These names are shared contracts and must not be changed without coordinating across agents.

The current platform uses Google Cloud services such as Vertex AI Agent Engine, Cloud Run, Firestore, Cloud Storage, Document AI, Secret Manager, and audit logging. The design also keeps clear interfaces for future AWS Bedrock or Azure AI Foundry support.

2. Agent overview

CRIZ is not only a chat assistant. It is an operations workflow agent.

It can:

- understand an operations, vendor, or office request;
- get approved company and compliance context;
- choose the correct workflow - vendor, compliance, contract, procurement, travel, meeting, or task;
- call approved tools, such as e-signature, calendar, procurement, and document storage connectors;
- use normal code for routing rules, checklists, and validations;
- stop and ask for human approval when an action is sensitive;
- save the result and the full audit history.

The external persona is a vendor and partner concierge: it guides outside parties through onboarding, document collection, and compliance verification, and keeps them informed without exposing internal-only data. The internal persona is an operations and executive assistant: it helps staff move contracts, travel, procurement, meetings, and tasks forward, and routes anything sensitive to the right approver.

Workflow orchestration is CRIZ's central responsibility - it sequences steps across vendor, compliance, contract, and approval stages, tracks status end to end, and hands off to people at the points where judgment or authority is required.

3. Problem statement

Many operations activities are still manual and slow:

- vendor onboarding is handled through scattered emails and manual document checks;
- contract processing is delayed by manual routing between reviewers and signers;
- compliance review creates bottlenecks because checks are inconsistent and hard to track;
- meeting coordination takes repeated back-and-forth across calendars and time zones;
- procurement requests and order status are tracked across disconnected spreadsheets;
- travel approvals are slow because requests sit in inboxes awaiting sign-off;
- workflow visibility is fragmented, so status questions require manual follow-up;
- audit and documentation gaps make later review and compliance reporting difficult.

The result is slower onboarding, higher administrative cost, more errors, and less time for higher-value operations and executive work.

4. Proposed solution

CRIZ will provide nine operations capabilities.

Capability	In simple terms	Main result
Vendor onboarding	Collect, verify, and route new vendor information and documents	Faster onboarding
Compliance coordination	Check vendor and contract details against compliance requirements and flag issues	Earlier risk detection
Contract lifecycle support	Track contract drafts, route for review and signature, and confirm activation	Faster contract turnaround
Procurement workflow management	Track purchase requests, vendor evaluations, and order status	Less manual tracking
Travel management	Prepare travel requests, route for approval, and track booking status	Faster approvals
Meeting coordination	Schedule meetings, send invites, and resolve calendar conflicts	Less scheduling effort
Task and approval routing	Assign tasks, send reminders, and route approvals to the right person	Better follow-through
Executive assistance	Support calendar management, correspondence drafts, and priority tracking	More executive time
Operational reporting	Build status reports and dashboards from workflow data	Better visibility

5. Version 1 scope

Version 1 includes:

- external vendor onboarding and document submission support;
- internal operations and office requests;
- compliance review workflow with flagging and routing;
- contract activation workflow, including e-signature coordination;
- approval routing across vendor, contract, procurement, and travel actions;
- meeting coordination and scheduling;
- task tracking and follow-ups;
- operational reporting with sources;
- cost, quality, security, and audit tracking.

Main output of version 1

A successful workflow returns a clear package:

Output	What it means
Status	Completed, waiting for approval, failed, or needs review
Result	Vendor record, compliance flag, contract status, meeting confirmation, travel booking, or task update

Output	What it means
Sources	The records or documents used to produce the result
Next action	What should happen next
Audit reference	A unique ID used to trace the full workflow
Cost summary	Model and service usage for the workflow

6. Out of scope for version 1

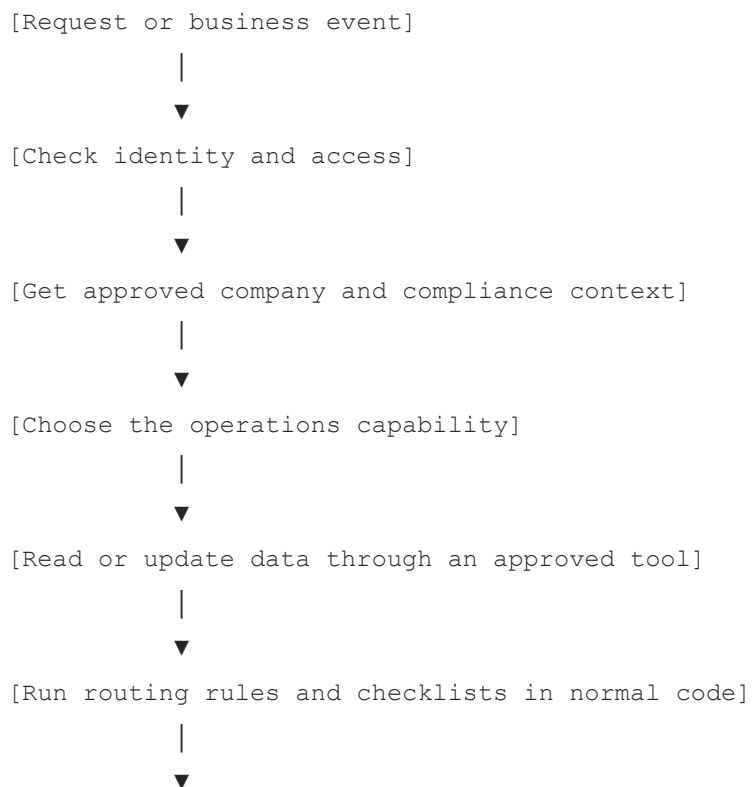
To keep the first release safe and easy to validate, CRIZ will not:

- approve a contract on its own;
- approve a vendor or compliance status on its own;
- make legal decisions or interpret contract terms as binding guidance;
- authorize payments, budgets, or other financial commitments;
- approve procurement orders independently;
- make autonomous executive decisions on a person's behalf;
- use unrestricted web browsing to support compliance or approval decisions;
- make a high-risk change from free-form AI text alone.

These limits reduce risk while the first version is tested.

7. High-level workflow

The standard workflow is:



[Ask for human approval when needed]



[Save the result and audit record]



[Return a clear response]

Workflow examples:

Vendor onboarding -> compliance review -> approval request -> contract activation -> audit record

Travel request -> approval routing -> scheduling -> status tracking -> completion

First end-to-end demonstration

The first sprint should prove this one complete story - vendor onboarding through to contract activation and audit logging - instead of building nine disconnected demos.

8. Business value and efficiency

The figures below are planning estimates. The real result must be measured during the pilot.

Expected time saving

Activity	Monthly volume	Current human time	Target human time	Possible time released
Vendor onboarding	50	90 min	30 min	50 hours
Compliance verification	100	45 min	15 min	50 hours
Contract coordination and review support	80	40 min	15 min	33 hours
Meeting scheduling and coordination	600	10 min	3 min	70 hours
Travel planning and approvals	150	25 min	10 min	38 hours
Procurement workflow tracking	200	20 min	8 min	40 hours
Task tracking and follow-ups	1,000	6 min	2 min	67 hours
Partner and vendor communications	300	8 min	3 min	25 hours
Total possible saving				About 373 hours per month

The base case counts only about 230 hours per month. This is more cautious because some cases will still need review, correction, or manual follow-up.

Illustrative ROI

Scenario	Hours counted as saved	Annual value	Build cost	Annual run and support	Estimated ROI	Estimated payback
Conservative	150 hours/month	\$63,000	\$20,000	\$10,000	177%	4.5 months
Base	230 hours/month	\$110,400	\$22,000	\$14,000	268%	2.7 months
Higher-value case	320 hours/month	\$172,800	\$26,000	\$17,000	362%	2.0 months

These numbers are not a promise. They show why the pilot is worth testing. After launch, ROI will be recalculated using actual time, actual cloud cost, actual error reduction, and actual onboarding and approval results.

9. Cost strategy

CRIZ will not use the most expensive model for every step.

It uses two model levels:

- Workhorse model - for routing, classification, short summaries, reminder drafts, and simple checklist validation.
- Reasoning model - for compliance exceptions, contract clause review support, multi-document vendor packets, and complex scheduling conflicts.

Only complex tasks should use the reasoning model. The pilot assumes that about 12% of model calls use the reasoning level. This is expected to reduce model cost by about 40% compared with using the reasoning model for every task.

Other cost controls are:

- read each document once and reuse the extracted data;
- use normal code for checklist logic, routing rules, and approval-state transitions;
- send only the needed fields to the model;
- limit model output size;
- reuse safe, stable context where allowed;
- limit BigQuery data scanned for reporting;
- run tool services only when they are needed;
- track cost by workflow and environment.

The working pilot estimate is \$360 to \$410 per month, including document-processing costs that range from \$50 to \$650 depending on vendor volume, with a warning threshold at \$420. At 3,000 workflows per month, this is about \$0.12 to \$0.14 per workflow.

10. Quality and success measures

CRIZ will be measured with clear targets.

Measure	Initial target
Correct operations workflow selected	At least 95%

Measure	Initial target
Important vendor or contract document fields extracted correctly	At least 95%
Compliance review workflow completed within SLA	At least 90%
Approval turnaround time, versus baseline	At least 40% faster
User satisfaction (vendor and internal)	At least 4.2 / 5
Action taken without valid human approval	0 cases
Duplicate vendor record or duplicate contract created by a retry	0 cases
External sensitive data shown to the wrong user	0 cases
Pilot cost per top-level workflow	No more than \$0.15
Simple request response time	95% within 8 seconds, excluding long document jobs
Complex workflow response time	95% within 20 seconds, excluding background jobs

Quality will be checked with repeatable test cases, not only by reading a few good examples.

11. Access control and security

Different users need different levels of access.

User type	Can read	Can prepare	Can approve or execute
External vendor	Own onboarding status and document checklist	Document submission and compliance forms	No
Operations coordinator	Assigned vendor and workflow records	Onboarding tasks, meeting coordination, task updates	No
Procurement officer	Procurement and vendor data	Procurement requests and vendor evaluations	No
Compliance reviewer	Compliance and audit data	Compliance review notes and flags	Compliance review sign-off only
Executive assistant	Calendar, travel, and task data	Meeting scheduling, travel requests, task routing	No
Department manager	Department workflow and approval queue	n/a	Approvals within department limits
Operations approver	Cross-department approval queue	n/a	Contract activation and vendor approval within limits
Auditor	Audit evidence	No	No

Security rules:

- every request must have a known user, role, company, and purpose;
- users only see data for their allowed company, vendor, and role;

- the person who prepares a sensitive action cannot approve the same action;
- external responses are checked for sensitive data before they are sent;
- secrets never appear in prompts, sessions, code, or logs;
- all tool calls and approvals are recorded;
- documents and tool responses are treated as untrusted data, not as instructions to the agent.

12. Data and storage

CRIZ handles vendor documents, contracts, compliance records, travel and procurement requests, and workflow status. This information can be sensitive.

The first implementation uses:

- Firestore for workflow state, approvals, operational records, and audit references;
- Cloud Storage for vendor documents, contracts, and generated files;
- Secret Manager for passwords, keys, e-signature credentials, and connector secrets;
- BigQuery only when larger reporting or analysis is needed;
- Audit Logs for the full, unalterable workflow history.

The contract management and document repository systems remain the official record of signed contracts and vendor agreements. Firestore supports the agent workflow; it does not replace the official record.

Session state should contain only the minimum needed information. Full document copies, secrets, and sensitive personal data should not be stored in the session.

13. Architecture principles

The following rules guide the build:

1. GCP first - the first working version uses Google Cloud.
2. Cloud-neutral core - operations rules and agent steps do not directly call a cloud SDK.
3. Configuration, not hard-coding - model and provider names come from configuration.
4. Standard interfaces - models, storage, tools, identity, secrets, scheduling, and audit use stable interfaces.
5. Typed schemas - important inputs and outputs use fixed, checked schemas.
6. Human oversight - sensitive actions stop for approval.
7. Auditability - every important step has a clear audit record.
8. Security by design - access, segregation of duties, and data protection are built in, not added later.

AWS Bedrock and Azure AI Foundry support are future options. Version 1 only prepares the interfaces and tests needed to add them later.

14. Delivery approach

The work follows a simple sequence:

Plan -> Design -> Build -> Test -> Pilot -> Improve

Stage	Main output
Planning	Scope, use cases, ROI, access rules, and requirements

Stage	Main output
Design	Workflow, tools, data, security, model routing, and tests
Build	Agent modules, interfaces, adapters, prompts, and tools
Test	Unit tests, workflow tests, security tests, and quality evaluations
Pilot	Real usage, cost measurement, user feedback, and error review
Improve	Fix weak areas, tune cost, and prepare the next capability

Before deployment, the project must pass document approval, security checks, cost reporting, agent evaluations, and budget-control checks.

15. Main risks and open decisions

Risk or decision	Why it matters	Planned response
Vendor and procurement system integration choice	It controls onboarding and procurement data flow	Select one provider for the first release
E-signature provider selection	It controls contract execution and tracking	Define one safe tool contract with approval checks
Approval workflow design	Different actions and amounts may need different approvers	Define an approval matrix before live use
Compliance policy definitions	CRIZ needs a clear, consistent compliance standard	Approve a fixed, versioned compliance policy set
vendor_onboarded and contract_status event reliability	CRIZ and FINA both depend on these shared events	Approve a fixed, versioned event schema
Official system of record	Duplicate truth creates operational and legal risk	Keep the contract and document repository as the official record
Cross-department data leakage	Vendor, HR, and finance data sensitivity differ	Enforce tenant and department checks in every request, query, and tool call
Future AWS/Azure support	Models and providers can change	Keep model and provider selection in configuration and confirm before deployment

16. Next steps

- Review and approve the Planning, Design, and Budget documents.
- Confirm the event schemas, approval rules, first vendor/procurement system integration, and first e-signature provider.
- Create the framework-based CRIZ project skeleton.
- Build the vendor-onboarding-to-contract-activation vertical slice with mocked tools.
- Add the human-approved approval routing flow.
- Add tests, evaluation cases, audit events, and cost tracking.
- Connect the approved GCP services and tools.
- Run the pilot and compare actual cost and value with this plan.

